

Digital & Systems Fluency

Comfort with how software actually works and where information lives — understanding abstraction at a basic level. This skill is increasingly urgent as AI tools become part of everyday work.

The student can...	Not Yet	Approaching	Proficient	Advanced
...locate where a file lives and retrieve it immediately.	Cannot locate files on their own device; does not distinguish local storage, cloud, and downloads folder.	Can find a file eventually but describes its location in vague terms ("it's saved somewhere").	Can state where a file is saved and why (local vs. cloud, which folder, which account) and retrieve it immediately.	Maintains a consistent storage system, can explain it to a peer, and recovers quickly when a sync or access issue occurs.
...describe a basic mental model of how a piece of software does its job.	Treats software as a black box; has no model for what happens between input and output.	Can describe the general purpose of a tool but not how data moves through it.	Gives a simple, accurate model: input goes in, it is processed this way, output comes out — without jargon.	Applies the mental model to predict what will happen in an unfamiliar tool or when something goes wrong.
...troubleshoot when technology does not behave as expected.	Stops working and waits for someone else to fix the problem.	Tries one thing (usually restarting) and escalates immediately if it does not work.	Works through a small set of logical steps, narrows down the likely cause, and escalates with a specific description of what was tried.	Diagnoses systematically, searches for solutions independently, and documents the fix so it can be reused.

Proficient = the competency is demonstrated reliably and independently (the target). Advanced = the student extends it unprompted.